Credit Name: CSE 2110 Procedural Programming 1
Assignment Name: Chapter 6 Mastery Exercise 5 (AddCoins)

The following questions can help you in thinking critically about your problem-solving processes:

Understanding the Problem
How did you approach understanding the challenge?
Working through the IPO chart before I started coding was how I understood the main steps of the challenge. I would ask for an amount of each coin, calculate the total monetary value, and then display the total for the user.
Were there any parts of the problem you found confusing at first? If so, how did you resolve that confusion?
Originally, I struggled to understand how to correctly create the getDollarAmount() method and then call it in the main method. For this I had to refer to the textbook and review the proper use of methods such as that.

Planning the Solution
Did you create a plan or break the problem into smaller steps before coding?
I broke the coding process into a few steps including: the output (asking the user for the number of each coin), creating the second method, calculating and returning the $total, and then finally displaying the total money to the user.
How did you decide on the tools, data structures, or algorithms to use?
The exercise outline was actually pretty specific so I had to follow those intructions, although its criteria did make sense. A second method would be used for calculations and would return a string. This helps improve the organization of the code and ensures that the final display will include the currency type. For calculations, I used doubles because it had to calculate money, which always requires 2 decimal places.

Implementation
Did you write the code in small pieces or attempt the entire solution at once?
While I was coding I would test small sections such as calculations, the method return, and the output. Just to make sure all the parts were working properly for when I put it all together.
How did you test your solution along the way to make sure it was working?
I would just run a few lines of test code (or the old code, plus the new lines I just added) to see if it worked. This would have helped me catch any errors early and be able to fix them without entirely rewriting my code.

Overcoming Challenges
What part of the problem was the most difficult for you?
Testing and altering the getDollarAmount() method to make sure it was working properly. It was an entirely a new concept for me so it was tricky to get correct right away.
How did you handle moments when you felt stuck or unsure of what to do next?
I asked some friends to help me improve my code and make sure it met the criteria or I would refer to the latest chapters in the textbook.

Learning
Was there anything you learned that you think will help you with future challenges?
While writing this code I think I have improved my understanding of methods considerably, nearly mastered when and how to use variable types and learned how to adapt to challenges when the code isn't quite working. This practical knowledge will greatly assist me while I navigate future coding problems.